

AI Music Creation

AI-Assisted Production Tools

Compiled by the Spaced Research Ledger

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AI features are now standard equipment in music production software. The four largest desktop workstations each shipped a significant one in the past year. This report covers what has actually been released, taken from the documentation of the companies that released it.

Section 1 covers the assistants and generators built into the workstations themselves. Section 2 covers stem separation, the technology that pulls a finished recording back apart into its instruments. Section 3 covers mastering, the final processing stage before release. Section 4 covers the industry agreements shaping how these vendors describe their own tools.

A note on sourcing belongs at the front of this one. Consumer music software is heavily covered by search-optimised review articles, and those articles are unusually unreliable on this subject.

During preparation, three claims carried by dated 2026 review articles turned out to be false. One attributed a feature to the wrong company. One described a product that does not exist. One listed a service that shut down in 2025 as a current market leader.

Every factual statement below is therefore cited to the company that ships the product, to the paper that published the result, or to the platform that sets the specification.

1. In-DAW Assistants and Generators

The assistant built into the workstation is now a product category of its own. It differs from a plugin in that it can see and change the session around it.

Recent Developments

Apple released Logic Pro 12 for Mac and iPad in January 2026, as part of the Apple Creator Studio launch [1]. Two features lead it. Synth Player is a fourth AI Session Player, joining Drummer, Bass Player and Keyboard Player. It generates chordal and synth bass performances under controls for complexity and intensity, in styles including 808 Bass, Pump Bass and Sequenced Bass [2]. Chord ID analyses harmonic content from an audio or MIDI region and fills in the project chord track automatically [1].

The two features connect. Because the chord track drives every AI Session Player, a progression identified by Chord ID can then be performed by any of them [1]. Logic Pro 12 is also the first version to drop Intel Mac support, requiring Apple silicon [2]. Apple updated the Creator Studio collection again in June 2026 [3].

Image-Line released FL Studio 2026 on 7 July 2026, free to existing owners under its lifetime updates policy [4]. Its assistant, Gopher, changed character in that release. Gopher first shipped in FL Studio 2025 answering production questions. In FL Studio 2026 it gained the ability to act inside a project, organising tracks, setting

levels, routing audio, and generating Piano roll and VFX scripts on request [4]. Image-Line describes the control capability as experimental [4].

The same release rebuilt the FLEX plugin and expanded FL Cloud with an improved Loop Starter, automatic project backup and further premium plugins [4].

Fender shipped Studio Pro 8.1 on 9 June 2026, the rebranded former PreSonus Studio One [5]. It added Studio Assistant, a natural-language help agent that answers questions inside the session. That agent is a public beta for Studio Pro+ subscribers, and it arrived alongside a native pitch-correction plugin with formant shifting [5].

Suno announced Suno Studio on 25 September 2025, a generative audio workstation that combines AI generation with multitrack editing [6]. Users can generate stem variations, work from uploaded audio, edit on a timeline with tempo and pitch control, and export both audio and MIDI [6].

Current State

The assistants divide cleanly by what they are allowed to touch. Fender's Studio Assistant answers questions about the software [5]. Apple's Session Players generate performances into tracks [2]. Image-Line's Gopher does both, and reaches furthest into the session by routing audio and setting levels directly [4].

Logic Pro also carries smaller AI integrations. Apple Intelligence Writing Tools, backed by ChatGPT, are available in the project and track notepads for summarising and organising notes [7].

Third-party assistants target the same space across multiple workstations. LIA is a natural-language assistant that creates tracks, sets tempo, routes sends and automates filters inside a running session. It is currently released only for Ableton Live, with versions for eight other workstations listed as in development [8]. MIDI Agent is a cross-platform plugin that generates melodies, chord progressions, basslines and drum patterns from text prompts, and lets the user choose which underlying model performs the generation [9].

One attribution deserves stating plainly, because review coverage frequently gets it wrong. Session Players are an Apple Logic Pro feature, documented by Apple. Ableton Live ships nothing under that name [10].

2. Stem Separation

Stem separation takes a finished stereo recording and reconstructs the individual instrument parts. It moved from a specialist service to a standard workstation feature during this period, and the research underneath it moved faster than the products.

Recent Developments

Ableton released Live 12.4 in May 2026 as a free update, ahead of Superbooth 2026 [11]. It improved Stem Separation in four ways. Only the audible portion of a file is now processed, and a selected portion of a clip can be separated in Arrangement View instead of the whole file. Separated stems can be merged back into a single track. Progress is reported by one unified bar rather than per stem [12].

LALAL.AI moved its separation from the cloud onto the user's machine over the course of 2026. Its first plugin arrived in February 2026 with a two-way vocal and instrumental split, running a new model called Lyra built for local processing [13]. By 21 May 2026 the plugin reached seven stems, covering vocals, instrumental, drums, bass, acoustic guitar, electric guitar and piano, with all processing performed locally [14]. Lyra uses GPU and NPU acceleration, ships as VST3 for Windows, macOS and Linux with AU in beta, and runs fully offline after activation apart from occasional subscription checks [15].

The company's cloud models advanced in parallel. Andromeda arrived in May 2026 with four-stem separation and improved bass handling [16], and gained a combined guitars stem and a rebuilt piano model in August 2026 [17].

LANDR upgraded its Stems plugin in April 2026 with AudioShake's next-generation models, adding dedicated piano and guitar separation alongside vocals, drums, bass and other [18].

Fender Studio Pro 8.1 integrated Moises directly into the workstation in June 2026 [19]. Both companies describe it as the first native integration of Moises separation, voice transformation and backing-track generation inside a major workstation [20]. Users on the free Moises tier receive 10 audio separations, 120 stem generation credits amounting to about 60 minutes, and 5 voice conversions per month [21].

Current State

Ableton's implementation splits a clip into vocals, drums, bass and other, is available in Suite only, and is powered by algorithms from Music AI, the company behind Moises [22]. It offers a High Speed and a High Quality mode, and uses the GPU on Apple silicon while Intel Macs and Windows machines process on the CPU [23].

Apple's Stem Splitter separates into six parts, adding guitar and piano to the same four, having gained those two in the Logic Pro 11.2 update of May 2025 [24] [25]. It runs entirely on-device with no network connection and requires Apple silicon [25]. It has since gained tempo-data preservation and one-click preset combinations such as acapella and instrumental [2].

The research layer sits ahead of the products. BS-RoFormer is a band-split transformer using rotary position embedding. It won the music separation track of the Sound Demixing Challenge 2023, and reaches 9.80 dB average signal-to-distortion ratio on the MUSDB18HQ benchmark without extra training data [26]. Mel-RoFormer maps frequency bins into overlapping mel-scale subbands rather than the non-overlapping bands of its predecessor, and outperforms it on vocals, drums and other stems [27]. A March 2026 paper extends BS-RoFormer to eight stems using a multi-stage curriculum and low-rank fine-tuning from four-stem checkpoints [28].

The open baseline remains Demucs. Meta's original repository is no longer maintained and work continues in the author's fork. There, `htdemucs` is the first hybrid transformer generation, and `htdemucs_ft` is a fine-tuned variant that takes about four times as long to run [29]. Ultimate Vocal Remover packages three separate architectures in one free application, each from different authors: the VR Architecture from `tsurumeso`, MDX-Net from `Kuielab` and `Woosung Choi`, and Demucs itself [30].

Commercial pricing spans a wide range. LALAL.AI bills in processing minutes, and a separation multiplies file length by the number of stem types requested, so a four-stem split costs roughly four times a vocal-only one

[31]. Its Orion network currently supports seven stems, and the company states it is expanding toward ten. The older Phoenix network covers piano, drums, bass, both guitars, synthesizer, and wind and string instruments [32].

Moises sells an annual subscription aimed at practising musicians, adding pitch and tempo control and chord detection on top of separation [33]. RipX DAW costs \$99 and RipX DAW PRO \$198 as one-time purchases, and allows editing individual notes inside a separated stem [34]. iZotope's RX 12 provides Music Rebalance for post-production work [35].

Unresolved Conflicts

The most common comparative claim about separation quality has no published basis. Review articles state that Demucs outperforms LALAL.AI's commercial model by a specific percentage on standardised benchmarks. No such comparison exists. The public leaderboards evaluate research models on MUSDB18HQ, and LALAL.AI does not publish a comparable figure for its own models. Settling it would require either vendor submitting to a public benchmark, which none of the commercial separation companies currently does.

3. Mastering

Mastering is the last processing stage before release. Two distinct product shapes compete here, and one of them lost a member during this period.

Recent Developments

iZotope announced Ozone 12 on 2 September 2025 [36]. It added three modules, Stem EQ, Bass Control and an Unlimiter, alongside a reworked Master Assistant and a new IRC 5 limiting algorithm for the Maximizer [37]. The Custom Master Assistant flow lets the user choose which modules run, set loudness targets and apply genre modifiers. Stem EQ applies equalisation separately to vocals, drums, bass and instruments within a stereo file [38]. The current shipping version is 12.1.0, released December 2025 [39].

CloudBounce ceased trading on 1 April 2025 [40]. Its parent, Image-Line, carried the underlying technology into FL Studio's mastering and FL Cloud, and offered former customers a perpetual FL Studio Fruity Edition licence [40]. CD Baby had already ended its CloudBounce partnership in February 2025, with previously mastered files available to customers only through February 2026 [41]. Any current listing of CloudBounce as an available service is out of date.

Splice released three generative AI tools on 15 April 2026, Variations, Craft and Magic Fit, all of which manipulate samples rather than master recordings [42]. Each compensates the original sample creator when a sound is used as a source or a variation is downloaded [42]. Splice's involvement in mastering is a marketplace one, renting iZotope's Ozone and LANDR's plugin on a rent-to-own basis rather than operating a mastering engine [43].

Current State

Automated mastering began as a web service. LANDR launched the first commercial one in 2014 out of Montreal, having spun out of MixGenius, and established the pattern of uploading a mix and receiving a finished master [44]. It did not move into a workstation plugin until 2023, before which it was browser-only [45]. That plugin sells for \$299 and brings the cloud-trained engine into the session with adjustable presets [45]. LANDR's own pricing page lists unlimited masters at \$9.99 per month, with the bundle adding samples and distribution starting at \$12.50 [46].

Ozone 12 comes in three editions, all of which include the Master Assistant. Advanced carries 20 editable modules that also load individually in a workstation, three add-on plugins and the Stem Focus workflow. Standard carries 14 modules that load only inside the main plugin. Elements carries Master Assistant with no individual module access [38]. Ozone 12 supports the current versions of every major workstation and requires macOS Ventura or later [39] [49].

Apple ships a Mastering Assistant inside Logic Pro at no additional cost, inserted on the stereo output, which analyses the mix and proposes a starting chain [47]. eMastered's reference mastering analyses an uploaded reference recording, then applies its loudness, balance and compression characteristics to the user's track. Reference Amount and Reference Intensity are exposed as expert controls, and settings can be saved as presets [48].

Delivery targets constrain all of this. Spotify normalises playback to -14 LUFS following the ITU-R BS.1770 methodology, and reserves about 1 dB of headroom for lossy encoding. A track with a higher true-peak maximum is therefore turned down less than one with more headroom [50].

Unresolved Conflicts

Two figures in the current record disagree and neither side is obviously wrong. iZotope describes Ozone 12 Advanced as 20 editable modules plus three add-on plugins, while its own marketing has been read as 21 individual plugins [38]. The difference is a counting convention rather than a factual dispute, and iZotope stating a single number in one place would settle it. Separately, Fender's Moises allotment of 120 stem generation credits has been reported both as 120 minutes and as roughly 60 minutes [19] [21]. Fender's own integration page gives the credit figure and the minute equivalent together, which favours the shorter reading.

4. Governance and Industry Framing

Vendors in this segment describe their tools through a shared vocabulary, and that vocabulary comes from a specific agreement.

Current State

Universal Music Group and Roland Corporation published the Principles for Music Creation with AI in March 2024, a set of seven principles on responsible use [51]. A coalition of more than 50 music technology organisations subsequently signed on. Those include LANDR, Splice, Native Instruments, Focusrite, Output,

Waves, Eventide, BandLab Technologies, Beatport and the National Association of Music Merchants [51]. The initiative maintains a standing public presence rather than existing only as a launch announcement [52].

Individual vendors have added their own commitments. Image-Line paired the FL Studio 2026 Gopher release with an explicit statement that neither cloud projects nor Gopher sessions are used to train AI models [53].

Unresolved Conflicts

Whether separating a copyrighted commercial recording is itself lawful remains unsettled. Vendors and comparison sites commonly describe personal and educational use as permissible while treating commercial distribution of extracted stems without clearance as infringement. That position is asserted rather than adjudicated. No court ruling specific to AI stem-separation tools was located, so the distinction rests on general copyright reasoning rather than on any decision about these tools. A ruling, or a licensing framework agreed between rights holders and separation vendors, would settle it.

About This Report

The Spaced Research Ledger is an automated system that gathers claims from live public sources, checks each one against its origin, and records every disagreement instead of merging it. Every stage runs on a different AI model, drawn from four systems across competing labs, so no single model both finds a claim and judges it. The Spaced Research Ledger is designed and maintained by Ridley DiSiena.

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